

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1000

By Slater

A RESOLUTION to commemorate Profound Autism Day.

WHEREAS, the definition of autism has evolved over the years, creating an increasingly heterogeneous spectrum; and

WHEREAS, while the entire spectrum deserves recognition and support, profound autism is a term intended to provide clarification about the autistic people who require 24/7 care from an adult caregiver throughout their lives; and

WHEREAS, people with profound autism also can have a severe intellectual disability or have minimal or no language. They are frequently excluded from research and support programs because of their unique needs; and

WHEREAS, the Centers for Disease Control released their first prevalence study on profound autism in April 2023; the research concluded that the percentage of eight-year-old children with profound autism in the United States was 26.7 percent, signifying that one in four children with autism have profound autism; and

WHEREAS, compared to children with non-profound autism, children with profound autism were more likely to be female, from racial and ethnic minority groups, of low socio-economic status, and born preterm or with low birth weight, and have self-injurious behaviors, seizure disorders, and lower adaptive scores; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we join with the Profound Autism Alliance in commemoration of March 17, 2026, as Profound Autism Day.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to

the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.